



Banking on talent: Defending champion Liverpool has broken the bank with record transfers for Florian Wirtz (in pic) and Hugo Ekitike. GETTY IMAGES

transfers for Florian Wirtz and Hugo Ekitike, and will hope to begin a new era, moving on from mainstay Trent Alexander-Arnold and forward Luis Diaz, who left for Real Madrid and Bayern Munich, respectively.

However, there will be underlying grief over the loss of forward Diogo Jota, who passed away in an accident last month.

“With everything that happened, it has been strange having to now try to carry on with work, with football. We will never forget Diogo, of course, but we just have to try to

honour his memory,” Liverpool’s captain Virgil van Dijk wrote in his matchday programme column.

Meanwhile, Manchester United will look for light at the other end of the tunnel after a season to forget last time around. With no trophies, an agonising Europa League final defeat and a 15th-place finish, manager Ruben Amorim had promised that “good days are coming”.

Signings like Bryan Mbeumo (20 goals, seven assists), Matheus Cunha (17 goals, six assists) and Benjamin Sesko (21 goals, five assists) indicate a strong arsenal for the Red Devils. With forwards having often fizzled out in a United shirt in the past, *a la* Antony and Angel Di Maria, the club will hope history doesn’t repeat this time. Meanwhile, Viktor Gyokeres, who became a sensation at Sporting CP under Amorim, will now play for Arsenal.

At the other end of the table, Sunderland returned to the Premier League after eight years, along with Leeds United, ensuring two of the

Newly promoted teams



Premier League

Sunderland, Burnley, Leeds United

La Liga

Levante, Elche, Real Oviedo

Bundesliga

FC Cologne, Hamburger SV

Serie A

Sassuolo, Pisa, Cremonese

Ligue 1

Lorient, Paris FC

Rest in peace: A mural in tribute to Diogo Jota who passed away in an accident last month. REUTERS

